

Class 5: Data Viz With ggplot

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Today we are exploring the **ggplot** package and how to make nice figures in R.

There are lots of ways to make figures and plots in R. These include:

- so called “base” R
- and add on packages like **ggplot**

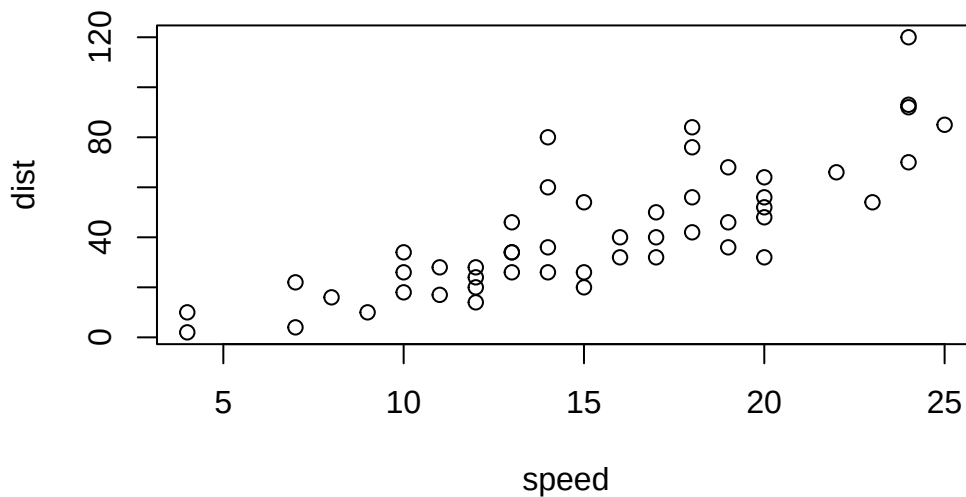
Here is a simple “base” R plot.

```
head(cars)
```

	speed	dist
1	4	2
2	4	10
3	7	4
4	7	22
5	8	16
6	9	10

We can simply pass this to the `plot()` function.

```
plot(cars)
```



Key-point: Base R is quick but not so nice looking in some folks' eyes

Let's see how we can plot this with **ggplot**

1st I need to install this add-on package. For this we use the `install.packages()` function - *WE DO THIS IN THE CONSOLE, NOT our report*. This is a one time only deal.

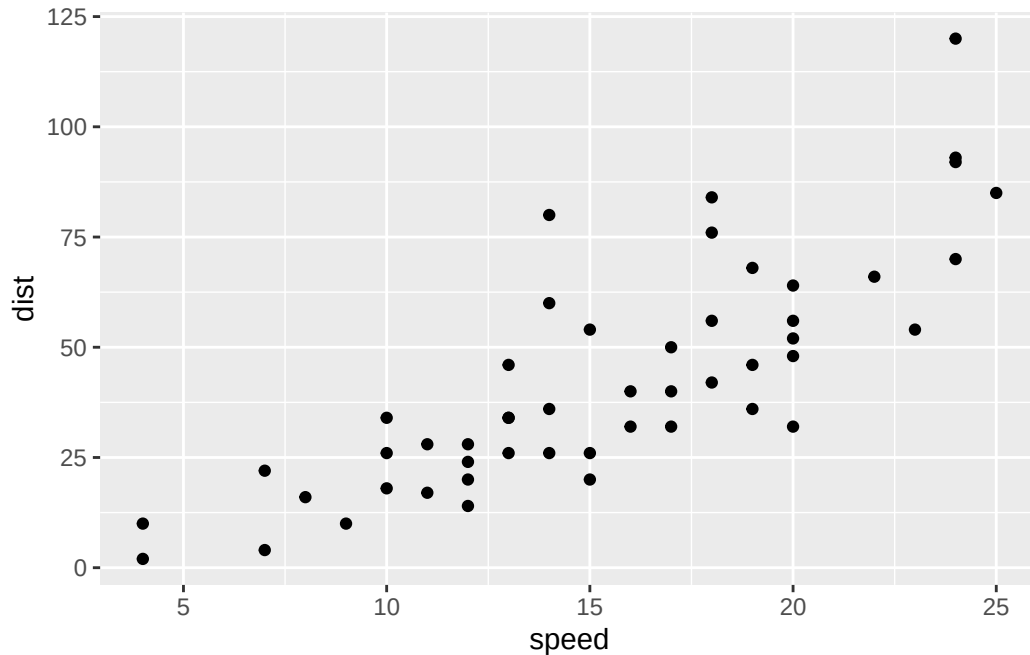
2nd We need to load the package with the `library()` function every time we want to use it.

```
library(ggplot2)
```

Every ggplot is composed of at least 3 layers:

- **data** (i.e. a data.frame with the things you want to plot)
- aesthetics `aes()` that map the columns of data to your plot features (i.e. aesthetics)
- geoms like `geom_point()` that srt how the plot appears.

```
ggplot(cars) +  
  aes(x=speed, y=dist)+  
  geom_point()
```



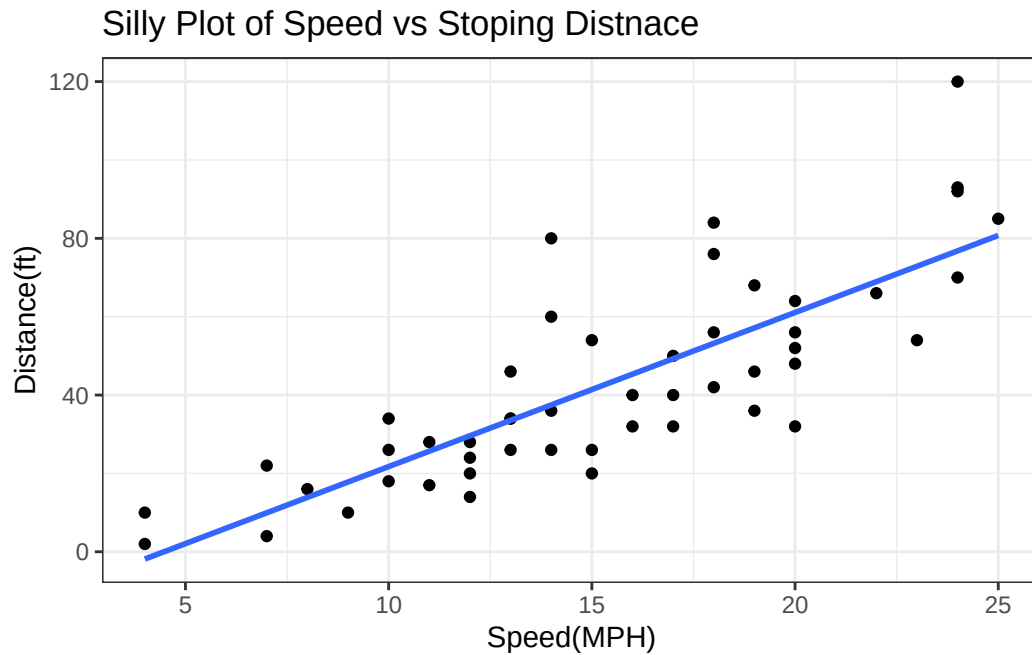
Key-point: For simple “canned” graphs base R is quicker but as things get more custom and elaborate then ggplot wins out...

Let's add more layers to our ggplot

Add a line showing the relationship between x and y Add title of the graph Add titles for x and y axis Change theme

```
ggplot(cars) +
  aes(x=speed, y=dist)+
  geom_point()+
  geom_smooth(method="lm", se=FALSE)+
  labs(title="Silly Plot of Speed vs Stopping Distnace")+
  xlab("Speed(MPH)")+
  ylab("Distance(ft)")+
  theme_bw()
```

`geom\_smooth()` using formula = 'y ~ x'



Going Further

Read gene expression data

```
url <- "https://bioboot.github.io/bimm143_S20/class-material/up_down_expression.txt"
genes <- read.delim(url)
head(genes)
```

	Gene	Condition1	Condition2	State
1	A4GNT	-3.6808610	-3.4401355	unchanging
2	AAAS	4.5479580	4.3864126	unchanging
3	AASDH	3.7190695	3.4787276	unchanging
4	AATF	5.0784720	5.0151916	unchanging
5	AATK	0.4711421	0.5598642	unchanging
6	AB015752.4	-3.6808610	-3.5921390	unchanging

Q1. How many genes are in this dataset?

```
nrow(genes)
```

```
[1] 5196
```

Q2. How many “up” regulated genes are there?

```
sum(genes$State=="up")
```

```
[1] 127
```

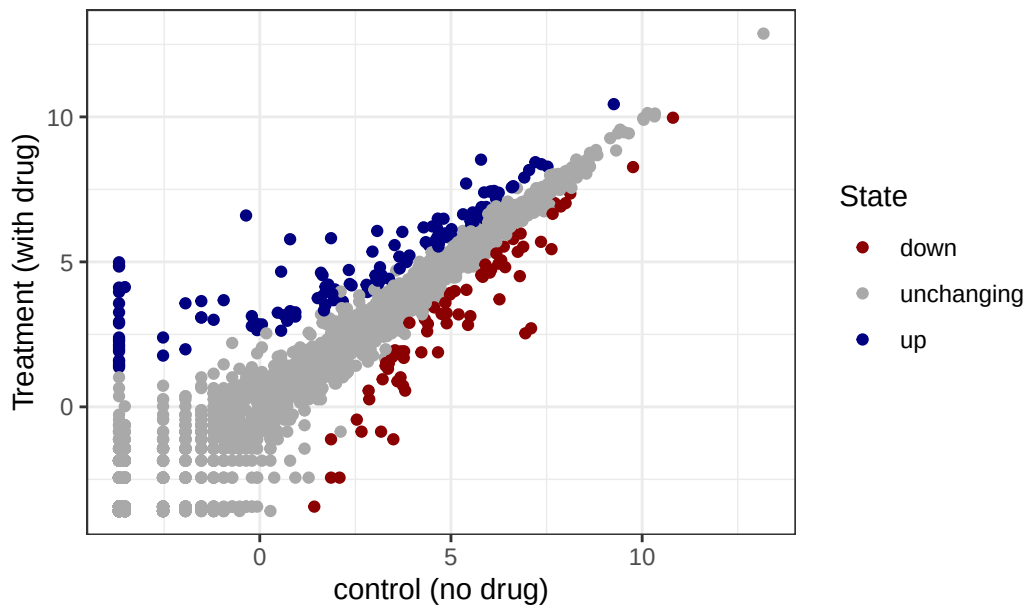
A useful function for counting up occurrences of things in a vector is the `table()` function

```
table(genes$State)
```

down	unchanging	up
72	4997	127

```
p <- ggplot(genes)+  
  aes(x=Condition1,y=Condition2)+  
  geom_point()+  
  aes(col=State)  
  
p +  
  scale_color_manual(values=c("darkred","darkgrey","navy"))+  
  labs(title="Expression changes upon drug treatment",  
        x="control (no drug)",  
        y="Treatment (with drug)")+  
  theme_bw()
```

Expression changes upon drug treatment



```
url <- "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/jennybc/gapminder/master/inst/extdata/gapminder.tsv"
gapminder <- read.delim(url)
```

```
head(gapminder,3)
```

	country	continent	year	lifeExp	pop	gdpPercap
1	Afghanistan	Asia	1952	28.801	8425333	779.4453
2	Afghanistan	Asia	1957	30.332	9240934	820.8530
3	Afghanistan	Asia	1962	31.997	10267083	853.1007

```
tail(gapminder,3)
```

	country	continent	year	lifeExp	pop	gdpPercap
1702	Zimbabwe	Africa	1997	46.809	11404948	792.4500
1703	Zimbabwe	Africa	2002	39.989	11926563	672.0386
1704	Zimbabwe	Africa	2007	43.487	12311143	469.7093

Q4. How many countries are in this data set?

```
length(table(gapminder$country))
```

```
[1] 142
```

Q4. How many continents are in this data set?

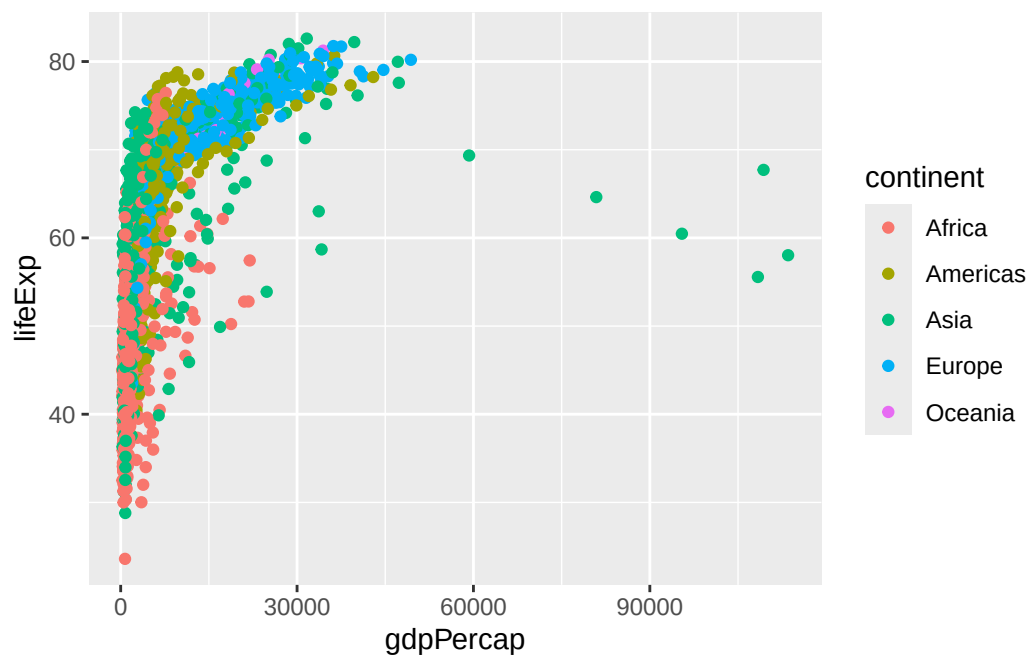
```
unique(gapminder$continent)
```

```
[1] "Asia"      "Europe"    "Africa"    "Americas" "Oceania"
```

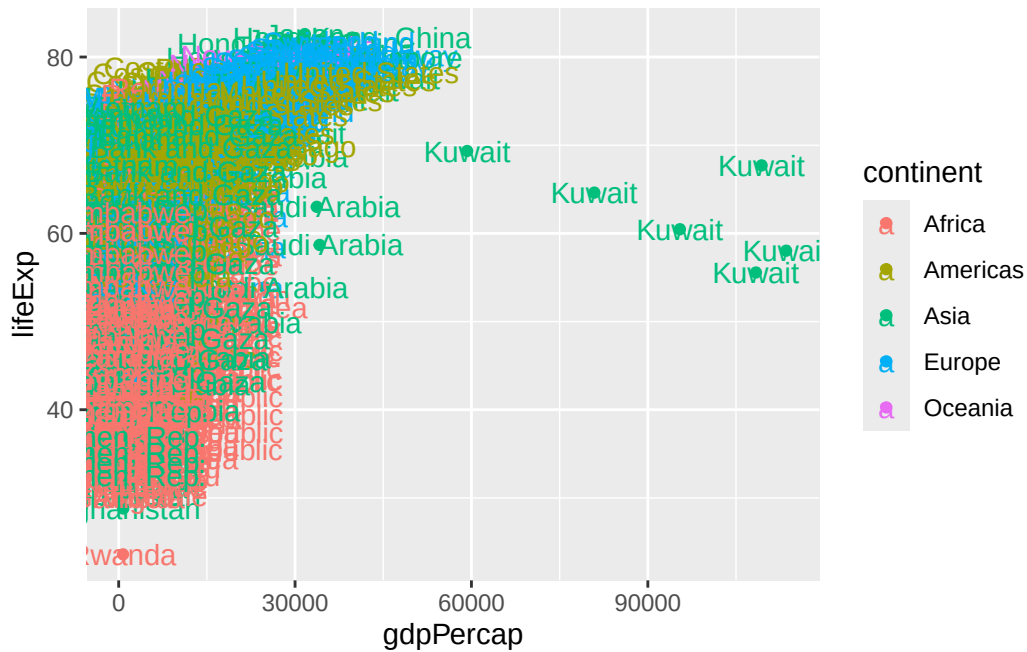
```
length(table(gapminder$continent))
```

```
[1] 5
```

```
ggplot(gapminder)+  
  aes(x=gdpPerCap, y=lifeExp,  
       col=continent)+  
  geom_point()
```



```
ggplot(gapminder)+
  aes(x=gdpPerCap, y=lifeExp,
      col=continent,
      label=country)+
  geom_point()+
  geom_text()
```



I can use the **ggrepel** package to make more sensible labels here.

```
library(ggrepel)
```

I want separate panels per continent

```
ggplot(gapminder)+
  aes(x=gdpPerCap, y=lifeExp,
      col=continent,
      label=country)+
  geom_point()+
  geom_text_repel()+
  facet_wrap(~continent)
```

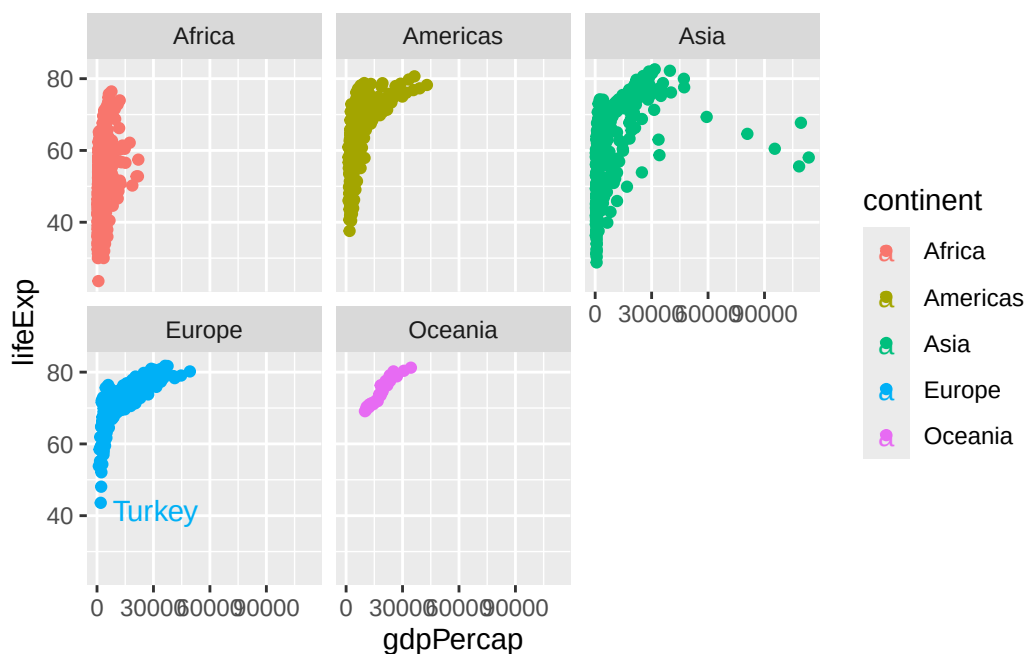
Warning: ggrepel: 624 unlabeled data points (too many overlaps). Consider increasing max.overlaps

Warning: ggrepel: 359 unlabeled data points (too many overlaps). Consider increasing max.overlaps

Warning: ggrepel: 300 unlabeled data points (too many overlaps). Consider increasing max.overlaps

Warning: ggrepel: 24 unlabeled data points (too many overlaps). Consider increasing max.overlaps

Warning: ggrepel: 396 unlabeled data points (too many overlaps). Consider increasing max.overlaps



Summary

ggplot2 makes it easier to create publication-quality, beautiful figures and allows you to build plots layer by layer using a consistent grammar. It is more concise for complex plots, offers sensible defaults, and handles legends and layout automatically. Base R plots are faster for simple, exploratory graphs but are harder to customize and refine for polished results. ggplot2 is preferred for finalized, professional visualizations, while base R is often used for quick, preliminary plots [1], [2], [3], [5], [4].